

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 7 5
♥ J 10 5 2
♦ Q J 5 4
♣ K 6 3

♠ K 10 4
♥ K Q 9
♦ A 10 7
♣ Q J 9 7



♠ Q J 9 6 3
♥ A 6 4
♦ 8 6 3
♣ 8 2

♠ A 8 2
♥ 8 7 3
♦ K 9 2
♣ A 10 5 4

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♠Q

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♠Q, the top of a broken honor sequence.

The top of a solid 3-card honor sequence is best, but as you can see, a broken 3-card sequence may work out just as good.

North will likely try the ♣ finesse, and when West wins the ♣K he will return a ♠ through North's ♠10.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 7 2
 ♥ K J 10 3 2
 ♦ 7
 ♣ A 7 4

♠ 8 5

♥ A Q 8 5

♦ 5 4 3

♣ Q J 10 2

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W		E
	S	

♠ A Q 10 6

♥ 7

♦ K J 9 6 2

♣ K 6 5

♠ 9 4 3

♥ 9 6 4

♦ A Q 10 8

♣ 9 8 3

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♦

Pass

4 ♠

1 ♠

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

Lead: ♠ 3

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4 ♠

Lead any ♠.

You have ♦ winners, but dummy will surely be short since he has at least 8 cards in the Major suits.

Partner has whatever ♥ strength your side possesses.

It is very likely that declarer will want to do some cross-trumping. To try to cut that down your best lead is a trump.

Just imagine that declarer wins the first ♠ in his hand and plays a ♥ to dummy's honors. North will win and play another trump. Whenever you win your first ♦ you will play your last trump.

As you can imagine, declarer will be in a whole lot of trouble.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 9 4 3
 ♥ 6 5 3
 ♦ 8 2
 ♣ 10 6 2

♠ 8 7 2

♥ K 8 7

♦ K Q J

♣ A 8 5 4



♠ 10 5

♥ J 10 4 2

♦ 9 6 5 4 3

♣ J 9

♠ A Q 6

♥ A Q 9

♦ A 10 7

♣ K Q 7 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

6NT

2NT

All Pass

6NT by South

Lead: ♥6

low ♠ you would have handed him his 12 trick on a platter.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6NT

Lead the ♥6.

You held this identical hand in Deal 3. The declarer was playing 3NT and the best lead was the ♠4, fourth down.

It's different when the contract is 6NT. Against 6NT you should make a passive lead, which means don't underlead any honors. Against 6NT you have little chance of establishing a suit to win four or five tricks. Instead, you just want to try to not give declarer an undeserved trick.

So any passive lead would be OK, you pick the ♥ just because they are less likely to have an unbid 4-card Major in either hand.

Declarer has 11 winners sitting there; if you had led a

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 10
 ♥ K Q J
 ♦ A Q J 9 8 7
 ♣ J 5

♠ K 8 5 4

♥ 8 6 5 2

♦ K 6 2

♣ 10 2



♠ A 2

♥ A 9 7

♦ 10 5 3

♣ A K Q 7 6

♠ Q 9 7 6 3

♥ 10 4 3

♦ 4

♣ 9 8 4 3

West	North	East	South
1♦	Pass	2♣	Pass
3♦	Pass	4NT	Pass
5♦	Pass	6♦	

All Pass

6♦ by West

Lead: ♠4

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6♦

Lead the ♠4.

Against a notrump slam it is best to make a passive lead so you don't give declarer an undeserved winner.

Against a suit slam the situation is very different. Against strong dummy bidding like this you are pretty sure that if you don't establish a winner early declarer will find something in dummy to discard losers on. In this hand it is dummy's ♣ suit.

Your most promising suit is ♠s. Obviously partner has a very weak hand, but if he has the ♠Q you can set up your ♠K before your King of trumps is dislodged.

Without a ♠ lead declarer will have smooth sailing.